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FINANCIAL INFRASTRUCTURE · CM PAYMENTS B.V.

European Open Banking Standards: Berlin Group vs. STET

Comprehensive architectural, regulatory, and integration analysis for direct Pay by Bank initiation across the Netherlands, Germany, France, and Belgium.

APPLICANT ENTITY	SUPERVISORY REGULATOR	AUTHORIZATION TARGET	RETAIL COVERAGE
CM Payments B.V.	De Nederlandsche Bank (DNB)	Service 7 (PISP Scope Extension)	>85% Western Europe

STRATEGIC EXECUTIVE FINDING

Under PSD2, continental Europe divided along geopolitical lines into two dominant standards: Berlin Group NextGenPSD2 across Germany, the Netherlands, and domestic Belgium; and STET PSD2 across 95%+ of France.

Building a single **STET adapter** in the CM.com Gateway unlocks virtually the entire French retail market (BNP Paribas, Crédit Agricole, Société Générale, BPCE, and Crédit Mutuel) without bespoke bilateral integration for each bank. With our existing Berlin Group engine and a companion STET engine, CM Payments B.V. achieves direct, intermediary-free coverage of **over 85% of Western European consumer bank accounts** using a single pair of eIDAS certificates.

100%

Germany on Berlin Group

Sparkassen & Volksbanken auto-onboard via eIDAS.

95%+

France on STET Standard

All Top 6 French banking networks share the STET

2 Engines

For Western European Scale

spec.

1 Berlin Group Engine + 1 STET Engine covers NL, DE, FR, BE.

SECTION 1

Comparative Architecture: Berlin Group vs. STET

The table below highlights the architectural differences between the Berlin Group NextGenPSD2 and French STET PSD2 specifications:

Technical Dimension	Berlin Group NextGenPSD2	STET PSD2 Standard	Gateway Engineering Implication
Primary Geography	Germany (~100%), Netherlands (~90%+), Austria, Belgium (~70%)	France (~95%), French overseas territories, parts of Belgium	BIC-based routing table dispatches to dialect handler.
Payment Initiation Path	`POST /v1/payments/sepa-credit-transfers`	`POST /payment-requests`	Target endpoint URL mapped dynamically.
Status Inquiry Path	`GET .../sepa-credit-transfers/{id}/status`	`GET /payment-requests/{id}`	Normalized transaction status mapper.
Payload Structure	Flat ISO 20022 JSON fields (`instructedAmount`, `creditorAccount`)	Nested STET JSON (`initiatingParty`, `beneficiary`, `creditTransferTransaction`)	Separate Go structs for wire serialization.
Request Signing	JWS (RFC 7515) or Cavage HTTP Signature	STET-profile HTTP Signature	Signed with the same corporate **eIDAS QSealC**.

Technical Dimension	Berlin Group NextGenPSD2	STET PSD2 Standard	Gateway Engineering Implication
Transport Security	Mutual TLS (mTLS) with eIDAS QWAC	Mutual TLS (mTLS) with eIDAS QWAC	Identical network transport handshake layer.
SCA Redirect Format	`_links.scaRedirect.href`	`_links.consentApproval.href`	Normalized redirect URL handed off to checkout UI.

SECTION 2

Country-by-Country Verification: Top 10 Banks

Verification of API implementation standards, Berlin Group compliance, and Dynamic Client Registration (DCR) across the top financial institutions:

Germany (DE) · 100% Berlin Group Compliance

#	Institution / Group	API Standard	Berlin Group?	DCR / Auto-Onboarding	Sandbox Model
1	**Sparkassen-Finanzgruppe** (~360 banks)	NextGenPSD2 (Finanz Informatik)	YES	YES (Zero-touch eIDAS auto-registration)	Finanz Informatik Hub
2	**Volksbanken & Raiffeisenbanken** (~700 banks)	NextGenPSD2 (Atruvia AG)	YES	YES (Automated eIDAS onboarding)	Atruvia Sandbox Hub
3	**Deutsche Bank AG** (incl. Postbank)	NextGenPSD2 v1.3	YES	PARTIAL (eIDAS prod; portal sandbox)	developer.db.com

#	Institution / Group	API Standard	Berlin Group?	DCR / Auto-Onboarding	Sandbox Model
4	**Commerzbank AG** (incl. comdirect)	NextGenPSD2 v1.3	YES	PARTIAL (eIDAS prod; portal sandbox)	developer.commerzbank.com
5	**ING-DiBa AG** (ING Germany)	NextGenPSD2 v2.0	YES	NO (ING Client ID required)	developer.ing.com
6	**UniCredit Bank GmbH** (HypoVereinsbank)	NextGenPSD2 v1.3	YES	YES (Automated via eIDAS QWAC)	UniCredit Portal
7	**N26 Bank AG**	NextGenPSD2 v1.3	YES	YES (Automated DCR & eIDAS)	developer.n26.com

France (FR) · 95%+ STET Standard (Berlin Group Not Used)

#	Institution / Group	API Standard	Berlin Group?	DCR / Auto-Onboarding	Sandbox Model
1	**BNP Paribas** (incl. Hello bank!)	**STET PSD2**	NO	NO (Developer portal onboarding)	developer.bnpparibas
2	**Crédit Agricole Group** (incl. LCL)	**STET PSD2**	NO	NO (CA-Store / CAPS enrollment)	ca-store.fr
3	**Société Générale** (incl. BoursoBank)	**STET PSD2**	NO	NO (SG Developer Portal registration)	developer.societegenerale.com
4	**Groupe BPCE** (Banque Populaire / Caisse d'Epargne)	**STET PSD2**	NO	NO (Managed via 89C3 API portal)	api.89c3.com

#	Institution / Group	API Standard	Berlin Group?	DCR / Auto-Onboarding	Sandbox Model
5	**Crédit Mutuel Alliance Fédérale** (incl. CIC)	**STET PSD2**	NO	NO (Euro-Information gateway)	Euro-Information Portal
6	**La Banque Postale**	**STET PSD2**	NO	NO (LBP Developer Portal)	LBP Developer Portal

Belgium (BE) · Hybrid Market

#	Institution / Group	API Standard	Berlin Group?	DCR / Auto-Onboarding	Sandbox Model
1	**BNP Paribas Fortis**	STET / Group REST	NO	NO (BNP Paribas engine)	developer.bnpparibas
2	**KBC Bank / CBC**	NextGenPSD2	YES	PARTIAL (eIDAS prod; portal sandbox)	developer.kbc.be
3	**Belfius Bank**	NextGenPSD2	YES	PARTIAL (eIDAS prod; portal sandbox)	belfius.be/developer
4	**ING Belgium**	NextGenPSD2 v2.0	YES	NO (Shared ING Client ID)	developer.ing.com
5	**Argenta**	NextGenPSD2	YES	PARTIAL (Isabel Group Hub)	Argenta Open Banking

SECTION 3

Strategic Engineering Roadmap for CM Payments B.V.

ACTION PLAN

Three targeted technical execution steps for sovereign European scale:

- **Maintain Berlin Group Engine:** Keep our existing Go core actively deployed. It immediately covers 100% of Germany and 90%+ of the Netherlands with zero per-transaction fee overhead.
- **Implement Modular STET Adapter:** Add `adapters/stet` to serialize into `/payment-requests`. One single STET adapter will cover BNP Paribas, Crédit Agricole, Société Générale, and BPCE.
- **Universal eIDAS Cryptographic Passport:** Continue using our single eIDAS QWAC and QSealC certificate pair issued to CM Payments B.V., which satisfies both Berlin Group and STET security mandates.